

can't just darken the image or bring lesser light on a certain area. You need to create a unique shadow that is shaped around the object.

Manipulating the area around the object is also important. This is done to create a shadow that adapts to the environment and adds realism to the image. Otherwise, images without shadows appear to be 2-D rather than being fully explored for their true potential. Added to that, shadows bring in the sense of depth that can't be recreated using any other technique.

Shadows are also essential when trying to focus attention towards a certain element or person of interest in the image.

Shadows can be cast using the Photoshop software available to all professional designers. One must understand the distance of the light source being portrayed in the image. If the LS is closer to the object, the shadow becomes darker and smaller in size. As the LS moves away, the shadow becomes duller. This is important to know if you're trying to design the perfect setting for the image. An LS that's too close will distract away from the image and create discomfort in the mind of the viewer.



Adding shadows to bring realism

You need to remember the three cardinal rules for casting shadows – shape, blur and blend. When you can master the three tools, you can move on to shadows. You can create the perfect shape replica, by copy-pasting and then darkening the image. This gives you the reference shadow on a disconnected image. This means that the shadow reference has been procured without the placement. The next step is to blur the shadow so that it